

accepted soon.

Work on a project. To make a pull request for starting your first contribution, go to the link *aka.ms/first-pr* that will take you to the GitHub repository called First Contributions. There you can access a tutorial on how to create your first pull request, which includes forking the repository, cloning the repository on your local machine, making a change to a file (for example, adding your username by creating a new branch), committing the change to a local copy of the project, pushing those changes to Github, and then creating the actual pull request where the project maintenance will be able to review your pull request, give a feedback, and accept/reject your changes.

As stated earlier, coding is not the only way to contribute to an open source project. There are many other ways. The first one is to promote the project and share it on different social media platforms. If you have experience with a particular project, you can answer some of the questions related to it on Stack Overflow or GitHub. It will be very helpful for project maintenance.

Another good way to make the first contribution is to go through the project documentation and fix errors. You can also write tutorials and translate the documentation into different languages. Making the project accessible to a lot of different people is well appreciated.

If you come across any bug, then do report it. If you do not report, then nobody's going to have a look and timely fix it. Although not a fun way, if you like writing unit tests for projects, especially after witnessing a bug that escaped someone else's notice, you can do so as it is one of the good ways to contribute to any open source project.

If you are a good designer, you can design a nice logo for a particular open source project. Like this,

there are multiple ways to contribute.

If you plan to work on an issue of a specific project, do assign yourself to the issue so that other people can know that someone else is working on it.

Submit your pull request.

Certain things can increase the chances of your pull request getting accepted. The first thing is to read the contribution guidelines before submission. It is good to describe the changes made and why for the project.

Just be mindful that some of the people maintaining an open source project won't be able to regularly check the repository. So, be patient and allow them time to go through your pull request.

Giving and receiving feedback is an essential part of the open source cycle. It helps to understand what needs to be changed. If you receive criticism, do not take it as a personal attack but as a means to further improve your skills. Since hundreds of big open source projects get reviewed every day, feedback on your contribution may take days—even months. Nevertheless, don't worry, you will eventually receive it.

Get ready for a new adventure

After all your hard work, unfortunately, everything may not work out the first time. May be your contribution did not fit the project's objective or someone else contributed in a better way. Do not worry, it happens. Remember to never give up. Once your contribution gets accepted, you will be motivated to contribute further.

So, if you love the philosophy of sharing content, receiving feedback, and being a part of a larger tech ecosystem, the life of an open source contributor is meant for you. **EFY**

The article is based on the talk 'How and why become an open source contributor' held at Open Source India 2021. The article has been compiled by Vinay Prabhakar Minj, a technology enthusiast

Share Your Knowledge

If you are an expert in your field of electronics, why not share your knowledge with the world?



Electronics For You invites electronics professionals and industry experts to write articles on their area of expertise and interest from different perspectives

Some of the topics we want you to write about are:

- **Smart World**
- **Artificial Intelligence**
- **Autonomous Cars**
- **Bio-Medical (Healthcare)**
- **Strategic (Defence) Electronics**
- **Audio-Video**
- **Project Reports**

So if you have an interesting topic or original article to share, please let us know at efyeditorial@efyindia.com

We would love to hear your good ideas too!

electronics
YOURS SINCE 1969 **FOR YOU**